

FOR THE 5:30 A.M. YOU HOPED WOULDN'T COME

Emergency sub plans with AI, in 15 minutes

You're sick, it's early, and the sub folder is three units out of date. This sheet is the system for exactly that morning: one master prompt that drafts a full sub day, four follow-up prompts that fill the gaps, and a once-a-semester list of what to keep printed so the AI never has to know anything about your actual students.

THE RULE, EVEN AT 5:30 A.M.

No student names or personal details in the prompt — ever.

The seating chart and medical notes live in the printed folder, not the chatbot.

The 15-minute system

- 1 **Run the master prompt (5 min).** Fill the brackets, paste it, and let it draft the whole day. It writes for a stranger, because your sub is one.
- 2 **Fix only what's wrong (5 min).** Reply to the draft: "period 2 is 40 minutes, not 55" · "swap the video for silent reading" · "add directions for turning in work." Three replies beats one rewrite.
- 3 **Send and go back to bed (5 min).** Email it with your standing sub folder items (below). The judgment calls — which students need what — are already handled by the printed folder, not the plan.

The master prompt

A full sub day, drafted for a stranger

"You are an experienced [GRADE/SUBJECT] teacher writing plans for a substitute who has never met these students and may not know the subject. Today's classes: [LIST PERIODS AND LENGTHS]. We are currently studying [TOPIC/UNIT]. Write a complete sub plan: for each period, a 5-minute bell-ringer, one main activity with numbered student-facing directions, an early-finisher task, and how to collect work. Nothing that needs a copier, a login, or subject expertise. Tone: calm and specific. End with a three-line note the sub can leave me about how it went."

Four gap-fillers

The no-tech backup

"The projector may not work. Give me a paper-and-pencil version of each main activity above, same learning goal, zero technology."

The review day (when you're too sick to think)

"Instead of new content, make this a review day on [LAST TOPIC]: a 15-question mixed review students can do independently, an answer key on a separate page, and one partner activity that stays quiet."

The two-day version

"I may be out tomorrow too. Extend this into a day two that builds on day one but still assumes a substitute: start with a 5-question warm-up on yesterday's work."

Management notes, without naming anyone

"Write a short 'how this class runs' section for a sub: routines for entering, bathroom, and turning in work: [DESCRIBE YOUR ROUTINES]. Do not reference any individual student — I keep those notes separately."

What AI can't pack: the once-a-semester folder

Fifteen minutes in August and January. These are the things that must be true and current on paper — no chatbot involved.

- **Seating charts** for each period — names live here, on paper, in the folder.
- **Health and safety notes** from the nurse's office, per your school's procedure.
- **Two trusted student helpers** per class and the neighbor-teacher to call.
- **Bell schedule, duty schedule, evacuation map** — the things subs actually ask for.
- **One evergreen emergency activity** per prep, printed, for the day the Wi-Fi dies too.

Never scramble again: our free 10-Minute AI Habit sheet has you drafting next-unit sub plans *before* you're sick. In our TpT store.

© Adam & Katelyn Spinozzi · AI-Ready School. Free resource: print and share within your school; please don't resell or repost online. Drafted with AI assistance, the same way we teach educators to use it, then researched, revised, and approved by two certified teachers.